



Operation: Look Closer

Year 1 | 45 minutes | Teacher-led | School grounds | No student devices

MISSION OBJECTIVE

Identify how one place in the school grounds helps meet the needs of a plant or animal.

Before the briefing

Print: page 2 once per pair (15 copies for 30 children). Keep pages 1, 3 and 4 for the teacher. Print A4 landscape at actual size.

Bring: pencils and firm writing surfaces. No collecting, cutting or craft supplies.

Choose: an accessible, familiar area with a plant, such as a tree, garden or pot. No flowers or animal sightings are needed.

Prepare: check weather, site hazards and school procedures. Set boundaries and arrange supervision and access support.

45-minute run sheet

0-5 min | Headquarters briefing

Read the mission on page 3; introduce the objective.

5-10 min | Prepare agents

Model one observation. Set boundaries and pair children.

10-25 min | Investigate

Observe one living thing and its place. Complete page 2 together.

25-35 min | Compare evidence

Pairs share what they saw and which need it may support.

35-45 min | Report and protect

Use the discussion prompts; choose one caring action.

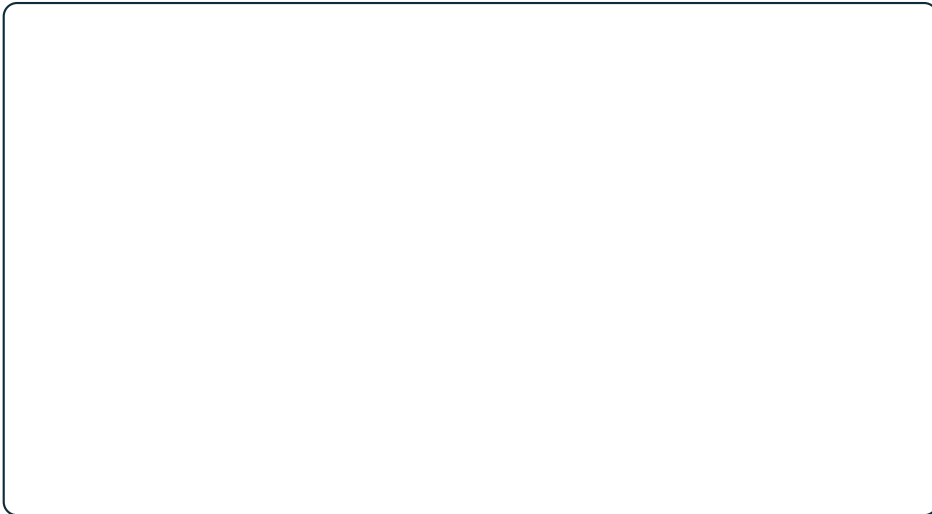
Operation: Look Closer

Our mission: find how a place helps a plant or animal get what it needs.

Agent names: _____ Date: _____

Our living thing: _____

Draw it and the place it lives.



1. In this place, we can see:

2. This helps our living thing get:

Need clues: air, water, light, food, shelter.

Tell your partner: How can we care for this place?



Lead the investigation

Read aloud from Headquarters

“You have been chosen for a special classroom mission. Headquarters needs sharp-eyed agents. Find one plant or animal and look closely at the place it lives. What helps it get what it needs? Draw your evidence, then report back. Leave every living thing and its home as you found it.”

Help children explain their evidence

Ask: What did you see? Which need could it help meet? What would we need to check?

Example: “I can see light falling on the plant. Light helps it make its own food.” Soil is not a plant's food.

Separate seeing from thinking: a hollow may offer shelter, but it does not prove an animal lives there. Dry soil does not show that water is available now.

Finish: choose one action, such as staying off plant roots or leaving shelter undisturbed. Do not feed wildlife.

Keep the mission accessible

Indoor option: observe a teacher-provided potted plant near a window, or a clear teacher-selected photo of a familiar school place. Discuss what the image cannot show.

Support: children may point, draw or dictate. One partner can record. Use an accessible seated observation spot where needed.

Observe only: no touching unknown plants, insects, fungi, nests or litter. No tasting, digging, moving logs or entering water.

Agency rule: stay inside the teacher's boundary and with the group. Follow school sun, weather, allergy and hygiene procedures.



Learning evidence & teacher feedback

Australian Curriculum v9.0: Year 1 Science

Suggested connections for this lesson. These are selected elements, not full coverage of a content description or achievement standard. No ACARA endorsement is claimed.

AC9S1U01	Pairs connect an observed place with a living thing's need. This samples one living thing, not all plant and animal needs.
AC9S1I03	The field report supports making and recording observations. Informal measurement is not assessed.
AC9S1I06	Pairs share a drawing and explanation using words such as plant, animal, water, light and shelter.

Source checked 26 September 2026: [QCAA: Year 1 Science, Australian Curriculum v9.0](#). Descriptions above are paraphrased. Teachers should check their local planning requirements.

A quick learning check

Can the child name or indicate a need, point to an observation, and connect the two? Record: independently / with support / revisit. Ask: "What makes you think that?"

Teacher feedback

Through the website contact page, tell us: Did you run it? Preparation and lesson time? Any confusion? What would help? No child names or photos are needed.

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Pilot timing is being tested. The caring action supports discussion of Sustainability; it is not a separate curriculum assessment.